

Vidhyut Gopinath

Software Engineer III / Cisco Secure Firewall

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Builds secure platforms from hardware interfaces and firmware through Linux, networking, and applications. Combines deep implementation ownership with the architecture, validation discipline, and coaching that make complex engineering work repeatable.

FIRMWARE / PLATFORM OS / SWITCHING / PHY / APPLICATIONS / SECURITY

EXPERIENCE

Cisco Systems, Inc.

Security Business Group / San Jose, CA

Software Engineer III	Nov 2024 - Present
Software Engineer II	Jan 2023 - Nov 2024
Technical Undergraduate Intern	Jun - Aug 2022

SOLE ENGINEER PLATFORM BRING-UP

Delivered Secure Firewall bring-up as the **sole engineer executing the scope of 4+ teams**, spanning firmware, FXOS, switching and PHY hardware, applications, datapath, and QDMA.

Built a data-driven platform-resource architecture; integrated image construction, signature validation, and post-quantum signatures for selected firmware bundles.

SECURITY AND FEDERAL COMPLIANCE

Contributed to **Project Glasswing** from Cisco's next-generation firewall OS team, **fixing critical vulnerabilities**.

Owned **Build Environment Security (BES) for federal compliance**, completing 33 improvements across segmented firmware builds, authenticated source access, artifact and dependency tracking, and publication validation.

PERFORMANCE AND MAINTAINABILITY

Consolidated FXOS Service Manager processes, reducing memory use and documenting the replacement architecture for maintainers.

ENGINEERING LEADERSHIP AND FOLLOW-THROUGH

Lead US Firewall participation in the AI-for-SDLC forum, coaching engineers on tradeoffs, critical review, and reusable development practices.

Built AI-assisted platform and firmware workflows backed by **280 local tests**; authored **29 engineering and onboarding pages**. Carry work through review, builds, artifact checks, and device validation.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

AT&T / Business Sales Expert	Sep 2017 - Apr 2022
Exceeded revenue targets; recognized by market leadership.	
Microsoft / Product Advisor	Sep 2017 - Sep 2018
Led weekly coding and robotics workshops; December 2017 MVP.	

SELECTED IMPACT

50.6%	lower peak virtual memory
31.0%	lower high-water resident memory FXOS Service Manager optimization
200+	engineers in the AI-for-SDLC forum audience

TECHNICAL DEPTH

Systems
C, C++, Python, shell, Linux, ARM64/x86
Platform
Firmware, FXOS, switching, PHY, applications, datapath, QDMA
Build and security
Make, Bazel, Yocto/BitBake, Jenkins, Git, signing, post-quantum cryptography
Diagnostics
GDB, Valgrind, address/leak sanitizers, kernel crash dumps

EDUCATION

San Jose State University
Bachelor's Degree Software Engineering May 2023